EASA Flight Time Limitations (Subpart FTL / CS FTL.1) for CAT Aeroplane Pilots and Cabin Crew — Reference Document (current as of 22 October 2026)

For EU scheduled and charter commercial air transport (CAT) aeroplane operations, the binding rules are still the 2014 Subpart FTL (Regulation (EU) No 965/2012 Annex III, as inserted by Regulation (EU) No 83/2014, applicable since 18 February 2016) skybrary plus CS FTL.1. europa luftfartstilsynet Pilots and cabin crew share the same FDP tables, cumulative limits and rest rules. Three differences matter: cabin crew FDP may be extended by up to 1 hour of earlier reporting (ORO.FTL.205(c)); raven cabin crew have their own in-flight rest table (CS FTL.1.205(c)(3)); and only flight crew augmentation unlocks long-haul extensions. luftfartstilsynet

TL;DR

- **Core limits (unchanged since 2016):** basic max FDP for acclimatised crew is 13:00 at best (1–2 sectors, reporting 06:00–13:29), falling to 9:00. Planned extension +1 h, max twice per 7 days; augmented crew 14–17 h (+1 h for a single sector over 9 h); commander's discretion +2 h (+3 h augmented). Duty 60/110/190 h per 7/14/28 days; flight time 100 h/28 days, 900 h/calendar year, 1,000 h/12 months. Rest ≥ preceding duty, minimum 12 h at home base or 10 h away (incl. 8 h sleep opportunity); 36 h reset incl. 2 local nights at most every 168 h.
- **Cabin crew follow pilot rules except:** FDP can be longer by the reporting-time difference (max 1 h) while still based on the flight crew's report time; minimum in-flight rest comes from a separate CS FTL.1.205(c)(3) table up to an 18:00 FDP (class 3 not allowed above 16:00, class 2 not above 17:00).
- **2026 status:** no change to scheduled/charter numbers; the only CS change since 2016 is ED Decision 2023/023/R (appropriate FRM for late finishes and long night duties, three night-duty subtypes). New FTL for air taxi, AEMS and single-pilot operations (EASA Opinion No 02/2026) was adopted by the Commission as a delegated act on 8 September 2026. Council document 12992/26 (Brussels, 10 September 2026) states that "It shall apply from 15 October 2028"; EASA's Opinion had proposed 1 September 2028. It is not yet in force. UK mirrors the 2016 EU rules without the 2023 amendment;

UAE (GCAA) and FAA Part 117 use materially different numbers.

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0. Quick-Reference Cheat-Sheet

Item	Limit	Reference
Basic max FDP, acclimatised	13:00 (best) → 9:00 (min), by report time and sectors (Table 2)	ORO.FTL.205(b)(1)
Max FDP, unknown acclimatisation	11:00 (1–2 sectors) → 9:00	ORO.FTL.205(b)(2)
Max FDP, unknown acclimatisation with FRM	12:00 (1–2 sectors) → 9:00	ORO.FTL.205(b)(3)
Planned extension without in-flight rest	+1:00, max 2× in any 7 consecutive days; max 5/4/2 sectors by WOCL encroachment; not allowed for reports 19:00–06:14	ORO.FTL.205(d); CS FTL.1.205(b)
Rest around a planned extension	+2 h pre- and post-flight rest, or +4 h post-flight	ORO.FTL.205(d)(1)
Augmented, 1 extra pilot	14 h (class 3) / 15 h (class 2) / 16 h (class 1)	CS FTL.1.205(c)(2)(i)
Augmented, 2 extra pilots	15 h / 16 h / 17 h	CS FTL.1.205(c)(2)(ii)
Long-sector bonus	+1 h if 1 sector has more than 9 h continuous flight time and max 2 sectors	CS FTL.1.205(c)(4)
In-flight rest minimum (flight crew)	90 consecutive min each; 2 consecutive h for landing pilots; max 3 sectors	CS FTL.1.205(c)(1)
Rest at destination after augmented FDP	≥ preceding duty or 14 h	CS FTL.1.205(c)(6)

Cabin crew early reporting	Extended by reporting difference, max 1:00; max FDP based on flight crew report caa	ORO.FTL.205(c)
Commander's discretion	+2 h (+3 h augmented); rest after ≥ 10 h; report to authority within 28 days if over 1 h	ORO.FTL.205(f)
Delayed reporting	Delay < 4 h: max FDP from original report; ≥ 4 h: more limiting of the two; ≥ 10 h undisturbed = rest	CS FTL.1.205(d)
Duty hours	60 h / 7 days; 110 h / 14 days; 190 h / 28 days caa	ORO.FTL.210(a)
Flight time (block)	100 h / 28 days; 900 h / calendar year; 1,000 h / 12 consecutive calendar months caa	ORO.FTL.210(b)
Split duty	Break ≥ 3 h net (min 30 min for pre/post-flight duties and travel); FDP + 50 % of break	CS FTL.1.220
Airport standby	FDP reduced by standby beyond 4 h; standby + FDP ≤ 16 h	CS FTL.1.225(a)
Other standby	Max 16 h; 25 % counts as duty; FDP reduced by standby beyond 6 h (8 h if augmented or split); 18 h awake cap	CS FTL.1.225(b)
Min rest, home base	≥ preceding duty or 12 h	ORO.FTL.235(a)
Min rest, away	≥ preceding duty or 10 h, incl. 8 h sleep opportunity	ORO.FTL.235(b)
Reduced rest (FRM only)	Min 12 h home / 10 h away; max 2 between recovery rests	CS FTL.1.235(c)
Recurrent extended recovery rest	≥ 36 h incl. 2 local nights; ≤ 168 h between; 2 local days twice per month	ORO.FTL.235(d)
Disruptive schedules	Late/night → early at home base: rest includes 1 local night; 4+ disruptive duties between recovery rests → next recovery rest 60 h	CS FTL.1.235(a)
Night duties	Consecutive nights: max 4 sectors per duty; appropriate FRM for night duties over 10 h and late finishes europa	CS FTL.1.205(a)

Time zones	Rotation with time difference ≥ 4 h: 2–5 local nights at home base (table); away: ≥ duty or 14 h	CS FTL.1.235(b)(3)
Records	24 months	ORO.FTL.245
Roster publication	14 days in advance	AMC1 ORO.FTL.110(a)

Operator-specific (approved IFTSS) flag. Every CS FTL.1 number, and everything stated as "the scheme shall specify", can differ for your operator. The competent authority approves each operator's Individual Flight Time Specification Scheme (IFTSS), which may deviate from CS FTL.1 (Article 76(7) of Regulation (EU) 2018/1139, formerly Article 22(2) of Regulation 216/2008) or derogate from the implementing rule (Article 71 of 2018/1139). Collective labour agreements may be more protective. **The operator's Operations Manual Part A, chapter 7, always prevails for the individual crew member.**

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1. Scope, legal structure and status (October 2026)

Legal layers

- **Implementing rule (binding):** Regulation (EU) No 965/2012, Annex III (Part-ORO), Subpart FTL, ORO.FTL.100–ORO.FTL.250, inserted by Regulation (EU) No 83/2014 (OJ L 28, 31.1.2014), applicable since 18 February 2016. skybrary +2 The Member State opt-out from ORO.FTL.205(e) (national in-flight rest rules) expired on 17 February 2017. eurocockpit +2 Companion Part-ARO points: ARO.OPS.230 (authority picks "early type" or "late type" disruptive schedules) and ARO.OPS.235 (IFTSS approval). legislation
- **Certification specifications:** CS FTL.1 (ED Decision 2014/002/R), amended by ED Decision 2023/023/R ("CS-FTL.1 Issue 1, Amendment 1" — night duties and late finish duties). europa +2
- **AMC/GM** to Part-ORO, plus EASA's ORO.FTL FAQs (interpretive, not binding).
- **Consolidated text:** EASA Easy Access Rules for Air Operations, Revision 24 (March 2026). europa europa

Scope and exclusions

- Subpart FTL applies to flight crew and cabin crew (not other service personnel). europa CS FTL.1 applies to scheduled and charter operations, excluding EMS, air taxi and single-pilot operations (CS FTL.1.100). luftfartstilsynet
- Under Article 8 of Regulation 965/2012, air taxi (non-scheduled on-demand CAT with aeroplanes of MOPSC 19 or less; Article 2(6)), aeroplane EMS and single-pilot CAT

aeroplane operations remain under Subpart Q of Annex III to Regulation (EEC) No 3922/91 ("EU-OPS Subpart Q") plus national law. Helicopter CAT (including HEMS) is under national law. europa +3

- Subpart Q (13 h basic FDP, −30 min per sector from the third, max −2 h, minus WOCL encroachment) is now legacy. wordpress EASA Opinion No 02/2026, §2.1, states: "Subpart Q has some fundamental gaps: it does not establish a maximum daily FDP for single-pilot and AEMS operations, and it does not provide for standby, in-flight rest and split duty", leaving "no uniform level of safety, and no level playing field".

Pending change — air taxi, AEMS and single-pilot FTL (RMT.0492 subtask 1 and RMT.0493)

- Process: NPA 2017-17 → NPA 2024-106 → EASA Opinion No 02/2026 (6 February 2026) → Commission Delegated Regulation C(2026) 6142 final (8 September 2026), transmitted to the Council on 10 September 2026 (document 12992/26). europa +4
- Content:
  - splits Article 8 into Subpart FTL (A) for scheduled/charter and Subpart FTL (B) for air taxi and AEMS;
  - defines "charter operation" for FTL as non-scheduled on-demand CAT with MOPSC of 20 or more;
  - adds definitions of AEMS flight and scheduled operation;
  - repeals Regulation 3922/91 from its date of application;
  - per Council document 12992/26, "It shall apply from 15 October 2028" (EASA's Opinion had proposed 1 September 2028); the updated ARO.OPS.235/ORO.FTL.125 apply from entry into force.
- Single-pilot scheduled/charter and single-pilot air taxi/AEMS are treated equivalently. The Opinion amends ORO.FTL.205 and ORO.FTL.240 for single-pilot flying, including an 8-hour limit on the daily FDP for single-pilot multi-sector duties.
- None of this is in force in October 2026.

Effectiveness reviews (Article 9b)

- Phase 1 (published 28 February 2019): increased probability of high fatigue on night duties and late finishes, for pilots and cabin crew; europa led to ED Decision 2023/023/R. europa
- Phase 2, "FTL 2.0" (EASA.2019.C31; Deliverable 2.6, 23 April 2025). NLR ran it with DLR, FIOH, Stockholm University and Jeppesen; per NLR's 9 July 2025 release it followed more than 220 flight and cabin crew at eight airlines. Findings:
  - "the basic set-up in the regulation of limiting the maximum basic FDP duration for

acclimatised crew as a function of the start time of the duty and workload (the number of sectors) is sound";
    - fatigue rises with FDP length and sectors (higher for more than 6 sectors);
    - highest fatigue on overnight FDPs over 11 h in an unknown state of acclimatisation (point estimate close to 0.7, few observations);
    - "38% of the pilots reported using controlled rest".
- No rule change from FTL 2.0 had been adopted as of October 2026. NLR's release says the study recommended "expanding current requirements for appropriate FRM and applying it to all flight duty periods lasting ten hours or more" and keeping the 18-hour awake cap for standby.

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2. Key definitions (ORO.FTL.105) and glossary

#	Term	Definition (summarised closely to the rule text)
(1)	**Acclimatised**	Circadian clock synchronised to the time zone where the crew member is; considered acclimatised to a 2-hour-wide band around local time at the point of departure. caa aviation If the next duty starts more than 2 h away in local time, Table 1 applies.
(2)	**Reference time**	Local time at the reporting point within a 2-hour band around the local time to which the crew member is acclimatised caa (GM: acclimatised to Helsinki, reporting in London → London time).
(3)	**Accommodation**	For standby and split duty: quiet place not open to the public, light/temperature control, furniture allowing sleep (GM: seat reclining ≥ 45°, ≥ 50 cm wide, leg/foot support), capacity for all crew, food and drink.
(4)	**Suitable accommodation**	For standby, split duty and rest: separate room per crew member, quiet, with bed, ventilation, temperature and light control, food and drink. aviation
(5)	**Augmented flight crew**	More than the minimum flight crew, allowing each to leave the post for in-flight rest and be replaced by a qualified flight crew member. wordpress
(6)	**Break**	Time within an FDP, shorter than rest, counting as duty, free of

		all tasks.
(7)	**Delayed reporting**	Postponement of a scheduled FDP by the operator before the crew member leaves the place of rest.
(8)	**Disruptive schedule**	Roster disrupting the optimal sleep window via early starts, late finishes or night duties. **Early type:** early start 05:00–05:59; late finish 23:00–01:59. **Late type:** early start 05:00–06:59; late finish 00:00–01:59. caa Authority chooses one type (ARO.OPS.230). caa
(9)	**Night duty**	Duty encroaching any part of 02:00–04:59 in the acclimatised time zone. caa
(10)	**Duty**	Any task for the operator: flight duty, administrative work, training/checking, positioning, some elements of standby.
(11)	**Duty period**	From required reporting until free of all duties, including post-flight duty.
(12)	**FDP**	From reporting for a duty including a sector or sectors until the aircraft finally comes to rest with engines shut down after the last sector as an operating crew member.
(13)	**Flight time (block time)**	Aeroplanes: from first moving from the parking place for take-off until at rest on the parking position with all engines or propellers shut down.
(14)	**Home base**	Location assigned by the operator where the crew member normally starts and ends duty and the operator is not normally responsible for accommodation.
(15)	**Local day**	24 h from 00:00 local time.
(16)	**Local night**	8 hours falling between 22:00 and 08:00 local time.
(17)	**Operating crew member**	Crew member carrying out duties in an aircraft during a sector. GM: remains operating during in-flight rest; in-flight rest counts in full as FDP and for ORO.FTL.210.
(18)	**Positioning**	Transfer of a non-operating crew member at the operator's behest, excluding home-to-reporting-place travel at home base and local transfers to/from the place of rest.
(19)	**Rest facility**	Bunk or seat with leg and foot support suitable for sleeping on

		board.
(20)	**Reserve**	Period of availability for an assignment notified at least 10 hours in advance.
(21)	**Rest period**	Continuous, uninterrupted, defined period free of all duties, standby and reserve.
(22)	**Rotation**	Duty or duties (≥ 1 flight duty) and rest out of home base, starting at home base and ending on return there for rest without operator accommodation.
(23)	**Single day free of duty**	For Directive 2000/79/EC: one day and two local nights free of duty and standby, notified in advance.
(24)	**Sector**	From first moving for take-off until at rest on the parking position after landing.
(25)	**Standby**	Pre-notified, defined availability for an assignment without an intervening rest period.
(26)	**Airport standby**	Standby at the airport.
(27)	**Other standby**	Standby at home or in suitable accommodation. caa
(28)	**WOCL**	02:00–05:59 in the acclimatised time zone. caa

Related terms not in ORO.FTL.105:

- **Unknown state of acclimatisation ("X")** — Table 1 / GM1 ORO.FTL.105(1).
- **Recurrent extended recovery rest** — ORO.FTL.235(d).
- **Split duty** — ORO.FTL.220 / CS FTL.1.220.
- **In-flight rest classes 1/2/3** — CS FTL.1.205(c).
- **Appropriate FRM** — GM1 CS FTL.1.205(a)(2): fatigue risk management through the safety risk management process within prescriptive limits, distinct from a fully-fledged FRM under ORO.FTL.120. europa

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3. Responsibilities, FRM, IFTSS and derogations

Operator responsibilities (ORO.FTL.110):

- publish rosters sufficiently in advance (AMC: 14 days);

- plan FDPs so crew remain sufficiently free from fatigue;
- set reporting times allowing for ground duties;
- consider the cumulative effects of long duty with minimum rest;
- avoid seriously disruptive patterns such as alternating day/night duties;
- apply the ARO.OPS.230 disruptive type;
- provide sufficient rest;
- plan and notify recurrent extended recovery rest;
- plan FDPs to be achievable;
- (j) **change a schedule or crew arrangements if actual operations exceed the maximum FDP on more than 33 % of the flight duties in that schedule during a scheduled seasonal period**, monitored through roster-robustness indicators (AMC1/GM1 ORO.FTL.110(j)).

Crew member responsibilities (ORO.FTL.115): comply with CAT.GEN.MPA.100(b) (do not operate when unfit or fatigued); make optimum use of rest opportunities and facilities. luftfartstilsynet

Fatigue risk management (ORO.FTL.120):

- When required, FRM is part of the management system and described in the Operations Manual. It covers policy, documentation, scientific principles, hazard identification (predictive, proactive, reactive), risk mitigation, safety assurance and promotion (guidance: ICAO Doc 9966).
- A fully-fledged FRM is mandatory for Table 4 (ORO.FTL.205(b)(3)), for reduced rest (CS FTL.1.235(c)(2)) europa and in practice for any CS deviation.
- "Appropriate FRM" is required for night duties over 10 h and late finishes (CS FTL.1.205(a)(2)). europa

Flight time specification schemes / IFTSS (ORO.FTL.125):

- Schemes must comply with the Basic Regulation, Subpart FTL and other law including Directive 2000/79/EC, and be approved before use.
- Deviations from the CS require a full description and safety assessment (former Article 22(2) of Regulation 216/2008, now Article 76(7) of 2018/1139).
- Derogations from the implementing rule follow former Article 14(6) (now Article 71).
- Within 2 years of a deviation or derogation, the operator must analyse data scientifically and report to the authority (ORO.FTL.125(d); ARO.OPS.235(d)). luftfartstilsynet

Collective agreements. Recital (4) of Regulation 83/2014 and the EASA FAQ confirm that more protective national social legislation and collective labour agreements are not

precluded. europa

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4. Home base (ORO.FTL.200 / CS FTL.1.200) and acclimatisation

- The operator assigns a home base to each crew member (ORO.FTL.200): a single airport location assigned with a high degree of permanence (CS FTL.1.200(a)). luftfartstilsynet
- **Change of home base:** the first recurrent extended recovery rest before duty at the new base increases to **72 h, including 3 local nights**; travel between bases is positioning (CS FTL.1.200(b); ORO.FTL.235(e)(3)). luftfartstilsynet
- GM1 CS FTL.1.200: consider temporary accommodation nearer base if the commute usually exceeds 90 minutes. luftfartstilsynet

4.1 Table 1 — Determining acclimatisation (ORO.FTL.105(1))

Rows: time difference (h) between reference time and local time where the next duty starts. Columns: time elapsed since reporting at reference time.

Time difference	< 48 h	48:00–71:59	72:00–95:59	96:00–119:59	≥ 120 h
< 4	B	D	D	D	D
≤ 6	B	X	D	D	D
≤ 9	B	X	X	D	D
≤ 12	B	X	X	X	D

B = acclimatised to departure time zone; **D** = acclimatised to where the next duty starts; **X** = unknown state of acclimatisation. luftfartstilsynet eurocockpit

Applying Table 1 (GM1–GM3 ORO.FTL.105(1)):

- The crew member stays acclimatised to the reference time for 47:59 after reporting.
- After 48 h they are "X" unless they remain in the first-arrival time zone long enough to become "D". europa
- If they move to another time zone while "X", they stay "X" until one of these happens:
  - they take the CS FTL.1.235(b)(3) rest at home base or at the new location; or
  - they become acclimatised there per Table 1 (using the greater time difference and

time since first reporting at home base).

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5. Maximum daily FDP

5.1 Table 2 — Basic maximum daily FDP, acclimatised crew (ORO.FTL.205(b)(1))

Start of FDP	1–2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
06:00–13:29	13:00	12:30	12:00	11:30	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00
13:30–13:59	12:45	12:15	11:45	11:15	10:45	10:15	09:45	09:15	09:00
14:00–14:29	12:30	12:00	11:30	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00	09:00
14:30–14:59	12:15	11:45	11:15	10:45	10:15	09:45	09:15	09:00	09:00
15:00–15:29	12:00	11:30	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00	09:00	09:00
15:30–15:59	11:45	11:15	10:45	10:15	09:45	09:15	09:00	09:00	09:00
16:00–16:29	11:30	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00	09:00	09:00	09:00
16:30–16:59	11:15	10:45	10:15	09:45	09:15	09:00	09:00	09:00	09:00
17:00–04:59	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00	09:00	09:00	09:00	09:00
05:00–05:14	12:00	11:30	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00	09:00	09:00
05:15–05:29	12:15	11:45	11:15	10:45	10:15	09:45	09:15	09:00	09:00

05:30–05:44	12:30	12:00	11:30	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00	09:00
05:45–05:59	12:45	12:15	11:45	11:15	10:45	10:15	09:45	09:15	09:00

Reading the table:

- −30 min per sector from the 3rd sector, floor 9:00.
- Every report from 17:00 to 04:59 is capped at 11:00 (EASA calls these "de facto night duties"). europa
- For consecutive night duties the FDP is computed with at most 4 sectors (CS FTL.1.205(a)(1)). luftfartstilsynet
- EASA FAQ: the absolute 16 h ceiling applies to basic FDPs and FDPs extended without in-flight rest. europa

5.2 Table 3 — Unknown state of acclimatisation (ORO.FTL.205(b)(2))

Sectors	1–2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Max FDP	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00	09:00	09:00

5.3 Table 4 — Unknown state of acclimatisation, operator has FRM (ORO.FTL.205(b)(3))

Sectors	1–2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Max FDP	12:00	11:30	11:00	10:30	10:00	09:30	09:00

Table 4 requires an approved FRM that continuously monitors that the required safety performance is maintained. luftfartstilsynet

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6. Extensions of FDP

6.1 Planned extension without in-flight rest (ORO.FTL.205(d), CS FTL.1.205(b))

- Up to +1 h, no more than twice in any 7 consecutive days, per individual crew member (EASA FAQ); europa europa acclimatised crew only. europa luftfartstilsynet

- Compensating rest: +2 h to both pre- and post-flight minimum rest, or +4 h post-flight. For consecutive extended FDPs, the extra rest between them is provided consecutively. luftfartstilsynet
- Must be planned in advance. Sector limits:
  - 5 if the WOCL is not encroached;
  - 4 if encroached by 2 h or less;
  - 2 if encroached by more than 2 h.
- Cannot be combined with in-flight rest or split duty in the same duty period (ORO.FTL.205(d)(4)). gov +2

Table — Maximum daily FDP with extension (CS FTL.1.205(b))

Starting time of FDP	1–2 sectors	3 sectors	4 sectors	5 sectors
06:00–06:14	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
06:15–06:29	13:15	12:45	12:15	11:45
06:30–06:44	13:30	13:00	12:30	12:00
06:45–06:59	13:45	13:15	12:45	12:15
07:00–13:29	14:00	13:30	13:00	12:30
13:30–13:59	13:45	13:15	12:45	Not allowed
14:00–14:29	13:30	13:00	12:30	Not allowed
14:30–14:59	13:15	12:45	12:15	Not allowed
15:00–15:29	13:00	12:30	12:00	Not allowed
15:30–15:59	12:45	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
16:00–16:29	12:30	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed

16:30–16:59	12:15	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
17:00–17:29	12:00	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
17:30–17:59	11:45	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
18:00–18:29	11:30	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
18:30–18:59	11:15	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
19:00–03:59	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed
04:00–05:59 (all 15-minute bands)	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed	Not allowed

Practical consequence: no planned extension for any report from 19:00 to 06:14, including early starts before 06:15. skai-tech caa

6.2 Extension with in-flight rest — augmented flight crew (ORO.FTL.205(e), CS FTL.1.205(c))

Class	Minimum standard (CS FTL.1.205(c))
Class 1	Bunk or other surface allowing a flat or near-flat sleeping position; reclines to ≥ 80° back angle to the vertical; separate from both flight crew compartment and passenger cabin; control of light; isolation from noise and disturbance.
Class 2	Cabin seat reclining ≥ 45° back angle to the vertical; pitch ≥ 55 in (137.5 cm); width ≥ 20 in (50 cm); leg and foot support; separated from passengers by at least a curtain; reasonably free from disturbance.
Class 3	Seat in cabin or flight crew compartment reclining ≥ 40° from the vertical; leg and foot support; separated from passengers by at least a curtain; not adjacent to any seat occupied by passengers.

Maximum FDP with in-flight rest — flight crew (CS FTL.1.205(c)(2) and (c)(4))

Augmentation	Class 3	Class 2	Class 1
+1 pilot (e.g. 3-pilot crew)	14:00	15:00	16:00
+2 pilots (e.g. 4-pilot crew)	15:00	16:00	17:00
+1 pilot, 1 sector > 9 h continuous flight time, max 2 sectors	15:00	16:00	17:00
+2 pilots, 1 sector > 9 h continuous flight time, max 2 sectors	16:00	17:00	18:00

Conditions (CS FTL.1.205(c)(1), (5)–(7)):

- max 3 sectors;
- every crew member gets at least 90 consecutive minutes of in-flight rest, and the landing pilots at least 2 consecutive hours (EASA FAQ: if the cruise is too short for this, no extension);
- rest is taken in cruise and allocated to optimise landing-pilot alertness (GM);
- all time in the rest facility counts as FDP;
- destination rest ≥ preceding duty or 14 h;
- no positioning sector to join the operating crew on the same flight.

These limits do not vary with report time or WOCL. sitcpla

6.3 Cabin crew in-flight rest (CS FTL.1.205(c)(3))

Cabin crew FDP is tied to the flight crew's augmented FDP. Each cabin crew member must receive at least:

Maximum extended FDP	Class 1	Class 2	Class 3
up to 14:30	1:30	1:30	1:30
14:31–15:00	1:45	2:00	2:20
15:01–15:30	2:00	2:20	2:40
15:31–16:00	2:15	2:40	3:00
16:01–16:30	2:35	3:00	Not allowed
16:31–17:00	3:00	3:25	Not allowed

17:01–17:30	3:25	Not allowed	Not allowed
17:31–18:00	3:50	Not allowed	Not allowed

Interpretation:

- The table reaches 18:00 to cover the flight crew maximum (4 pilots, class 1, long-sector bonus) and/or the cabin crew's earlier report. It does **not** by itself authorise an 18 h FDP.
- UK CAA guidance (CAP 1265): the operator must show the cruise allows **every** cabin crew member the minimum rest for the selected band, considering rest facilities, cabin crew numbers and service requirements. For example, with class 1 rest and every cabin crew member getting at least 2:35, the FDP may be nominated against the 16:30 limit.

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7. Cabin crew–specific rules (what differs from pilots)

Topic	Flight crew	Cabin crew	Reference
Basic FDP tables (2, 3, 4)	Apply	Apply, but max FDP computed from the **flight crew** report time	ORO.FTL.205(b), (c)
Earlier reporting for briefing	n/a	FDP extended by reporting difference, **max 1 h**; FDP starts at cabin crew report	ORO.FTL.205(c)
Extension without in-flight rest	+1 h, 2× per 7 days	Same (per individual)	ORO.FTL.205(d)
In-flight rest extension	Table by extra pilots and class	Minimum rest table by FDP band and class	CS FTL.1.205(c)(2) vs (c)(3)
Commander's discretion	Commander decides after consulting crew	Applies to whole crew; all crew consulted on alertness	ORO.FTL.205(f)(3)
Cumulative limits, rest, standby, reserve, disruptive schedules, time-zone rest	Same	Same	ORO.FTL.210–235; CS FTL.1.225–235

- Earlier reporting does **not** allow a later finish than the flight crew's maximum; it only lets the cabin FDP start earlier.
- There is no separate cabin crew Table 2 and no flat extra hour — a key difference from the UAE rules.
- Reporting times may legitimately differ between flight and cabin crew (EASA FAQ).
- Extra cabin crew carried within basic limits do not need in-flight rest; it is required only when the FDP is extended under CS FTL.1.205(c).

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8. Unforeseen circumstances — commander's discretion (ORO.FTL.205(f))

- **Applies only** to unforeseen circumstances starting at or after reporting.
- **FDP increase:** the maximum from ORO.FTL.205(b) and (e) or ORO.FTL.220 may be increased by **up to 2 h**, or **up to 3 h if augmented**. caa GM1 ORO.FTL.205(f)(1)(i): use the basic FDP from (b) as the base even if the FDP was a planned extension under (d). legislation luftfartstilsynet
- **Last sector:** if the increase is exceeded after take-off on the final sector, the flight may continue to destination or alternate. luftfartstilsynet
- **Rest:** may be reduced but never below 10 h. wordpress luftfartstilsynet
- **Commander's duties:**
  - reduce the FDP and/or increase rest where severe fatigue could result ((f)(2); (a)(2));
  - consult all crew on alertness ((f)(3));
  - report to the operator ((f)(4)).
- **Reporting to the authority:** if the increase or reduction exceeds 1 h, the operator sends the report with comments to the authority within 28 days ((f)(5)). The process must be non-punitive and described in the Operations Manual ((f)(6)).
- **AMC1 ORO.FTL.205(f):** discretion is exceptional and should be avoided at home base and hubs where standby/reserve crew should be available. Consider WOCL, weather, operational complexity, malfunctions, training duties, sectors, circadian disruption and individual condition.
- **EASA FAQ:** discretion is needed only when the actual FDP will exceed the **maximum allowed** FDP.

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9. Delayed reporting (ORO.FTL.205(g), CS FTL.1.205(d))

Delayed reporting is allowed only with Operations Manual procedures that set:

- a notification time allowing the crew member to stay in suitable accommodation;
- a contact mode;
- minimum/maximum notification times;
- avoidance of sleep disturbance (GM1 CS FTL.1.205(d)).

Records must be kept.

Situation	Max FDP based on	FDP starts counting
One notification, delay **< 4 h**	Original reporting time	At the delayed reporting time
One notification, delay **≥ 4 h**	More limiting of original or delayed time	At the delayed reporting time
Second notification	Per rows above	1 h after the second notification, or at the original delayed time if earlier
Delay **≥ 10 h**, crew not further disturbed	Delay counts as a **rest period**	New FDP calculated normally

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10. Cumulative duty and flight time limits (ORO.FTL.210)

Limit	Value
Duty	60 h in any 7 consecutive days caa
Duty	110 h in any 14 consecutive days caa
Duty	190 h in any 28 consecutive days, spread as evenly as practicable caa
Flight time (as operating crew)	100 h in any 28 consecutive days caa
Flight time	900 h in any calendar year caa

Flight time	1,000 h in any 12 consecutive calendar months caa

What counts:

- post-flight duty counts as duty (minimum time set in the Operations Manual; ORO.FTL.210(c), AMC1); caa
- positioning counts in full as duty (ORO.FTL.215(b));
- airport standby counts in full (ORO.FTL.225(c));
- other standby counts at 25 % (CS FTL.1.225(b)(3));
- reserve does not count (CS FTL.1.230(b));
- in-flight rest counts in full (GM1 ORO.FTL.105(17));
- flight time counts only sectors flown as operating crew.

Limits apply identically to pilots and cabin crew.

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11. Positioning, split duty, standby and reserve

11.1 Positioning (ORO.FTL.215)

- Positioning after reporting but before operating counts as FDP but not as a sector.
- All positioning counts as duty.
- Positioning after the last operating sector is duty, not FDP.

11.2 Split duty (ORO.FTL.220, CS FTL.1.220)

Rule	Detail
Minimum break	3 consecutive hours on the ground (CS FTL.1.220(a))
Excluded	Post/pre-flight duties and travel, min total 30 min, actual times in Operations Manual (b)
FDP increase	Up to **50 % of the break** added to the ORO.FTL.205(b) maximum (c) luftfartstilsynet
Suitable accommodation	Required for a break ≥ 6 h or one encroaching the WOCL (d) europa
Otherwise (accommodation)	Break time beyond 6 h or inside the WOCL does not count for the extension (e)

Combinations	Not with in-flight rest (f), not with a planned extension (ORO.FTL.205(d)(4)), not after reduced rest (ORO.FTL.220(c))
Counting	Break counts in full as FDP (ORO.FTL.220(b))

Net break	**FDP increase**
3:00	+1:30
4:00	+2:00
5:00	+2:30
6:00	+3:00
8:00 (suitable accommodation, no WOCL)	+4:00

11.3 Standby (ORO.FTL.225, CS FTL.1.225)

- Standby and airport duties must be rostered with start/end notified in advance. Airport duty counts in full as duty and the FDP counts from the airport duty report. The operator provides accommodation for airport standby.
- **Airport standby (CS FTL.1.225(a)):**
  - if no FDP follows, it is followed by ORO.FTL.235 rest;
  - if an FDP starts, the FDP counts from its start and the max FDP is reduced by standby beyond 4 h;
  - **standby + FDP max 16 h**.

Other standby (CS FTL.1.225(b))

Rule	**Detail**
Max duration	16 h
Awake time	Procedures must keep standby + FDP from exceeding **18 h awake**
ORO.FTL.210 counting	25 % of standby counts as duty
After standby	Rest per ORO.FTL.235
End	On reporting at the designated reporting point
Called within first 6 h	Max FDP counts from reporting

Called after 6 h	Max FDP reduced by standby beyond 6 h
In-flight rest or split duty	6 h thresholds become 8 h
Standby starting 23:00–07:00	Time between 23:00 and 07:00 does not count toward reductions until contacted
Response time	Must allow reasonable time from place of rest to reporting point

- GM: a full minimum rest between call and report is not standby; the actual report time is used for ORO.FTL.235.
- FTL 2.0 found the 18 h awake cap "could be working effectively", but prior sleep matters more than time awake. europa

11.4 Reserve (ORO.FTL.230, CS FTL.1.230)

- Reserve must be rostered. The scheme sets the maximum reserve period duration and the number of consecutive reserve days (within ORO.FTL.235(d)).
- An assigned FDP counts from reporting.
- Reserve does **not** count as duty for ORO.FTL.210 or ORO.FTL.235.
- Each reserve day includes a rostered **8 h no-contact period**. Assignments need **at least 10 h notice**, which may include the 8 h period (GM2).
- Unused reserve cannot retrospectively become recurrent extended recovery rest (GM1 ORO.FTL.230(a)).

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12. Rest periods (ORO.FTL.235, CS FTL.1.235)

12.1 Minimum rest

- **Home base (ORO.FTL.235(a)):** ≥ preceding duty or 12 h, whichever greater. If the operator provides suitable accommodation at home base, the away minimum may apply ("back-to-back", GM1 ORO.FTL.235(a)(2)).
- **Away (ORO.FTL.235(b)):** ≥ preceding duty or 10 h, incl. an 8 h sleep opportunity plus travel and physiological needs. AMC1: physiological needs = 1 h; if travel to accommodation exceeds 30 min, rest increases by twice the excess. luftfartstilsynet
- **Special cases:**
  - after a planned extension: +2 h pre/post or +4 h post (ORO.FTL.205(d));

- after an augmented FDP: ≥ duty or 14 h (CS FTL.1.205(c)(6));
- after commander's discretion: never below 10 h (ORO.FTL.205(f)(1)(iii)).

12.2 Reduced rest (ORO.FTL.235(c), CS FTL.1.235(c))

- Only under FRM.
- Minimum 12 h at home base, 10 h away.
- The next rest is extended, and the next FDP reduced, by the difference between the normal minimum and the reduced rest.
- Max 2 reduced rests between recurrent extended recovery rests; split duty may not follow.
- In practice it only bites after duties longer than 12 h at base or 10 h away.

12.3 Recurrent extended recovery rest (ORO.FTL.235(d))

- Minimum **36 h including 2 local nights**.
- **No more than 168 h** between the end of one and the start of the next.
- Increased to **2 local days twice every month**.
- Applies to reserve crew too (GM1 CS FTL.1.230(c)).

12.4 Disruptive schedules and night duties

The early/late type is set by the national authority (ARO.OPS.230). An unofficial blog, the "Understanding EASA ORO.FTL 2016" site (ARO.OPS.230 page), lists:

- early type: Germany, Austria, Ireland, Italy, Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Finland, Switzerland, Poland, Czechia, Croatia, Cyprus, Malta and others;
- late type: France, Spain, the Netherlands, the UK, Belgium, Greece, Luxembourg, Latvia, Slovakia and Turkey;
- Bulgaria: "Most Restrictive".

This is not an EASA source — verify with your authority or Operations Manual.

	Early type	**Late type**
Early start	Duty starts 05:00–05:59	Duty starts 05:00–06:59
Late finish	Duty ends 23:00–01:59	Duty ends 00:00–01:59
Night duty (both)	Encroaches any part of 02:00–04:59	Same

- **Transition at home base:** late finish/night duty → early start requires 1 local night in the

intervening rest (CS FTL.1.235(a)(1)). raven EASA FAQ: this applies when the early duty is an FDP, or a standby/airport duty leading to an FDP — not, for example, a simulator session.

- **Accumulation:** 4 or more night duties, early starts or late finishes between two extended recovery rests → the second extended recovery rest becomes **60 h** (CS FTL.1.235(a)(2)).
- **Consecutive nights:** max 4 sectors per duty (CS FTL.1.205(a)(1)); with the 17:00–04:59 row this caps them at 10:00. europa
- **Appropriate FRM** (ED Decision 2023/023/R) for night duties over 10 h and late finish duties (CS FTL.1.205(a)(2)). europa europa
- **Three night-duty subtypes** must be distinguished and ranked by probability of high fatigue at top of descent (CS FTL.1.205(a)(3)):
  1. FDPs starting 02:00–04:59;
  2. FDPs ending 02:00–05:59 and starting at 01:59 or earlier;
  3. FDPs ending at 06:00 or later and starting at 01:59 or earlier.
- **Guidance (GM1–GM5 CS FTL.1.205(a)(2)):**
  - avoid long nights after recovery rest;
  - delay preceding finish times progressively;
  - start blocks with a shorter FDP;
  - roster blocks of identical duties;
  - allow no more than one transition between disruptive types between recovery rests;
  - crew should sleep in the afternoon before nights;
  - the Prior Sleep Wake Model is one possible tool.
- Training item (k), "optimum use of sleep opportunities", was added to AMC1 ORO.FTL.250. europa

12.5 Time-zone compensation (CS FTL.1.235(b))

The operator must monitor rotations and adapt rosters.

At home base after a rotation with a time difference of 4 h or more — minimum local nights of rest (CS FTL.1.235(b)(3)(i)):

Max time difference (h) between reference time and local time where crew rests	< 48 h	48:00–71:59	72:00–95:59	≥ 96 h
≤ 6	2	2	3	3

≤ 9	2	3	3	4
≤ 12	2	3	4	5

Columns: time elapsed since reporting for the first FDP of the rotation.

- **Away**, after an FDP with a time difference ≥ 4 h: rest ≥ preceding duty or 14 h ((b)(3)(ii)). Once between recovery rests, this may also apply at home base with suitable accommodation.
- **Alternating east–west/west–east rotations:** at least 3 local nights at home base between them ((b)(4)).
- **GM:**
  - the elapsed-time clock stops on return to home base for rest;
  - for rotations of 3 or more FDPs, use the greatest time difference from the original reference time;
  - if crossing in both directions, use the most zones crossed in any one FDP.

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13. Nutrition, records and training

- **Nutrition (ORO.FTL.240):** a meal and drink opportunity during the FDP, especially when it exceeds 6 h. The Operations Manual sets minimum duration and meal windows (AMC1 example: an FDP from 11:00 to 22:00 gives two meal opportunities).
- **Records (ORO.FTL.245), kept 24 months:**
  - flight times;
  - start, duration and end of each duty period and FDP;
  - rest periods and days free of duty;
  - assigned home base;
  - reports on extended FDPs and reduced rest.
  - Copies go on request to the crew member or another operator. Records for crew working for more than one operator are also kept 24 months.
- **Fatigue management training (ORO.FTL.250, AMC1):** initial and recurrent, for crew, rostering staff and managers. Syllabus:
  - regulatory requirements;
  - sleep and circadian basics;
  - causes and effects of fatigue;

- countermeasures;
- lifestyle;
- sleep disorders;
- long-range and heavy short-haul effects;
- multiple time zones;
- crew responsibility for rest;
- since 2023, optimum use of sleep opportunities before and during disruptive duties.

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14. Worked examples (standard CS FTL.1; check your IFTSS)

Example 1 — Acclimatised, 2 sectors, report 06:00.

- Table 2, row 06:00–13:29, 1–2 sectors → **max FDP 13:00**, ending by 19:00 on-blocks.
- Planned extension: CS FTL.1.205(b) row 06:00–06:14 → **Not allowed**. A 07:00 report would allow 14:00, subject to the 2-in-7 limit and extra rest.
- Commander's discretion → up to **15:00**.

Example 2 — Long-haul, 3 pilots, class 1 bunk, 1 sector of 12 h.

- CS FTL.1.205(c)(2)(i)(C) → 16:00, plus (c)(4) → **17:00**.
- Each pilot needs ≥ 90 consecutive min rest; the landing pilots ≥ 2 consecutive h.
- Discretion up to +3 h. Destination rest ≥ max(preceding duty, 14 h).
- With 4 pilots and class 1: 17:00, or **18:00** with the long-sector bonus.

Example 3 — Cabin crew on Example 2.

- Flight crew max 17:00 → cabin crew in class 1, band 16:31–17:00 → **3:00** minimum each.
- Class 2 seats → 3:25; class 3 → not allowed above 16:00.
- If cabin crew report 1 h earlier, their FDP may be 18:00 from their own report; band 17:31–18:00 (class 1 only) → **3:50** each.

Example 4 — Cabin crew reporting 1 h earlier (short-haul).

- Flight crew report 07:00, 3 sectors → 12:30, ending 19:30.
- Cabin crew report 06:00 → max FDP still based on 07:00 (12:30) plus the 1:00 difference = 13:30 from 06:00, ending 19:30.
- Reporting at 05:30 (1:30 earlier) still allows only +1:00: 13:30, ending 19:00.

Example 5 — Split duty.

- Report 08:00, 4 sectors → 12:00.
- Ground time 4:30 with 30 min allotted to duties and travel → net break 4:00 → +2:00 → **max FDP 14:00**.
- Accommodation is required; suitable accommodation only if the break is ≥ 6 h or touches the WOCL.
- Not allowed after reduced rest or with a planned extension.

Example 6 — Home standby.

- Other standby 07:00–23:00 (16 h). Called 14:00, reports 15:00 for 2 sectors.
- Standby 8 h → FDP reduced by 2 h. Table 2 row 15:00–15:29 → 12:00 – 2:00 = **10:00**, ending 01:00.
- Awake check: woken 06:30 → 01:00 = 18:30, beyond the 18 h awake procedure, so the operator must shorten the FDP or provide rest.
- Duty counted for ORO.FTL.210: 25 % × 8 h = 2 h plus the FDP.

Example 7 — Rest after a rotation.

- Rotation resting 9 h behind home base, returning 80 h after first report → CS FTL.1.235(b)(3)(i) row ≤ 9, column 72:00–95:59 → **3 local nights** at home base.
- Away from base after a 9:00 duty with a 50 min hotel transfer: 10:00 + 2 × 20 min = **10:40** (AMC1 ORO.FTL.235(b)).

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15. Comparison with other regimes

Item	EASA (EU)	UK CAA	UAE GCAA (Subpart Q model)	FAA Part 117 (US)
Legal basis	Reg. 965/2012 Subpart FTL + CS FTL.1 (incl. 2023 amendment)	UK Reg. 965/2012 (retained) + UK CS FTL.1	CAR-OPS 1 Subpart Q content, now housed in CAR-AIR OPS Part-ORO Subpart FTL (".G" points)	14 CFR Part 117
Covers cabin crew?	Yes	Yes	Yes (CAR-OPS 1.1135)	**No** — pilots only; flight attendants under Part 121

				(§121.467)
Max basic FDP (2-pilot, best)	13:00 (1–2 sectors)	13:00	14:00 (report 08:00–12:59, 1 sector), −45 min per extra sector, floor 9:00	14 h (report 07:00–11:59, 1–2 segments) ecfr
Duty limits	60/110/190 h per 7/14/28 days	Same	Flight crew 55 h (60 h for delays)/7 days, 95 h/14, 190 h/28	FDP 60 h/168 h; 190 h/672 h
Flight time	100 h/28 days; 900 h/calendar year; 1,000 h/12 months	Same	Pilots 100 h/28 days; 900 h/12 months	100 h/672 h; 1,000 h/365 days
Min rest	≥ duty or 12 h (home) / 10 h (away, incl. 8 h sleep)	Same	≥ duty or 12 h (11 h away with suitable accommodation)	10 h incl. 8 h uninterrupted sleep opportunity ecfr
Weekly reset	36 h incl. 2 local nights per 168 h	Same	Days-off rules (e.g. 7 days off per 28)	30 consecutive h free per 168 h ecfr
Cabin crew specifics	FDP + reporting difference (max 1 h); separate in-flight rest table	Same (CAP 1265 guidance)	Cabin FDP **1 h longer** than flight crew; duty 60 (65)/105/210 h; flight time 100 h/28 days and **1,000 h**/12 months; rest ≥ duty – 1 h or 11 h	Part 121, not Part 117

UK.

- The UK kept Subpart FTL and CS FTL.1 after Brexit, so tables and limits are identical, and the UK CAA uses "late type" disruptive schedules. wordpress
- **Difference:** the UK CS FTL.1.205(a) in the CAA regulatory library still reads "appropriate fatigue risk management … night duties of more than 10 hours", without EASA's 2023 extension to late finishes or the three night-duty subtypes. caa

- Guidance: CAP 1265.

UAE (relevant if Dubai-based).

- UAE operators do **not** apply EASA ORO.FTL. CAR-AIR OPS Issue 01 (16 May 2021) Part-ORO ORO.FTL.100.G stated: "All operators shall comply with Subpart Q of CAR-OPS 1, Issue 07 of 03 September 2020". wordpress gcaa
- The current Part-ORO is Issue 03 (15 April 2025), with "Subpart FTL – amended"; its section titles mirror Subpart Q topics. gcaa gcaa
- Figures above come from the Subpart Q text effective 1 January 2017, which also provides:
  - In-flight relief: at least 3 h rest; a bunk extends the FDP by half the rest taken, max 18 h (19 h cabin crew); a seat by one third, max 15 h (16 h cabin crew).
  - Split duty: a break of 3–10 h extends the FDP by half the break.
  - Commander's discretion: maximum 3 h except in emergency; report to GCAA within 14 days if over 2 h. wordpress
  - Days off: max 7 consecutive duty days; 2 consecutive days off in any 14; at least 7 days off in any 28; a single day off includes two local nights (34 h minimum). wordpress
  - Two-pilot sectors over 7 h count as several sectors (e.g. 7:01–9:00 = 2 sectors acclimatised). wordpress
- Issue 07 (2020) and Issue 03 (2025) may have changed some figures; check your operator's GCAA-approved scheme.

FAA Part 117.

- Pilots only.
- Table B: FDP 9–14 h by acclimated start time and segments; hraizon augmented limits in Table C.
- Rest 10 h with an 8 h sleep opportunity; 30 h free in every 168 h.
- 100 flight hours per 672 h, 1,000 per 365 days; FDP 60 h per 168 h and 190 h per 672 h.

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16. Caveats

- **Currency:** Regulation 965/2012 Subpart FTL as amended by Regulation 83/2014; CS FTL.1 Issue 1 Amendment 1 (ED Decision 2023/023/R); EASA Easy Access Rules for Air Operations Revision 24 (March 2026); rulemaking status as of 22 October 2026.
- **Pending delegated act:** the 8 September 2026 Commission Delegated Regulation on

air taxi, AEMS and single-pilot FTL was not yet published in the Official Journal; its 2028 date and content may change. Do not apply it yet.

- **CS figures are defaults:** an approved IFTSS may differ; your Operations Manual Part A chapter 7 governs legality; CLAs can be stricter.
- **Authority choices vary:** early vs late disruptive type and FRM approvals (Table 4, reduced rest) differ by State; the per-country early/late list is from a secondary compilation.
- **Interpretive material:** EASA ORO.FTL FAQs and UK CAP 1265 are aids, not law.
- **UAE figures** are from the 2017 Subpart Q text; the 2025 CAR-AIR OPS Part-ORO Subpart FTL text was not verified line by line.
- **Official texts to keep alongside:**
  - Regulation (EU) No 83/2014 and consolidated Regulation (EU) No 965/2012 (EUR-Lex);
  - EASA Easy Access Rules for Air Operations;
  - ED Decision 2023/023/R;
  - EASA ORO.FTL FAQ;
  - EASA Opinion No 02/2026 and Commission document C(2026) 6142;
  - EASA FTL effectiveness reports (2019; FTL 2.0, 2025);
  - UK CAA regulatory library and CAP 1265;
  - GCAA CAR-AIR OPS Part-ORO (Issue 03, 15 April 2025);
  - 14 CFR Part 117 (eCFR).